

SYED ABID ALI

SENIOR AZURE CLOUD & DEVOPS ENGINEER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Azure Cloud & DevOps Engineer with 13+ years of IT experience, including 6 years specializing in Azure Cloud Infrastructure and DevOps. Expert in delivering cloud solutions aligned with Microsoft CAF and DevSecOps best practices.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Azure Cloud Architecture:** Azure Landing Zones, Management Groups, Subscriptions, Hub-Spoke Network Architecture, VNets, Subnets, VNet Peering, NSGs, UDRs, Azure Firewall, Bastion, NAT Gateway, Load Balancer, Application Gateway (WAF), VMs, VMSS and Storage Accounts.
- **Infrastructure as Code (IaC):** Terraform (reusable modules, remote backends, state locking, workspaces, import, drift detection, state management).
- **CI/CD & Automation:** Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions (multi-stage YAML -based pipelines, Environments, Security scanning, Validation, Build, Test, Approval gates and Automated Deployments).
- **Identity & Security:** Microsoft Entra ID, RBAC, MFA, PIM, Managed Identities, Service Principals, Azure Policy, Key Vault and OIDC/Workload Identity Federation.
- **DevSecOps:** TFLint, tfsec, Checkov, GitLeaks, TruffleHog and Infracost integrated into CI/CD pipelines for quality and security controls.
- **Monitoring & FinOps:** Azure Monitor, Log Analytics, dashboards, alerts, operational visibility, Azure Cost Management and optimization.
- **Business Continuity:** Azure Backup, Recovery Services Vault, Azure Site Recovery, recovery planning and RTO/RPO-driven disaster recovery.
- **Version Control:** Git, GitHub, Azure Repos, trunk-based development, pull requests, code review and branching strategies

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior DevOps Engineer

Mar 2023 - Present

Ericsson Global

- Delivered Microsoft CAF-aligned Azure Landing Zones using Hub-Spoke topology, integrating VNets, subnets, Azure Bastion, VMs, VMSS, Load Balancers, Application Gateway with WAF and Azure Firewall.
- Implemented secure network segmentation, VNet peering and UDR-based traffic routing through Azure Firewall, enabling centralized inspection and controlled connectivity across enterprise workloads.
- Automated Azure infrastructure provisioning with Terraform, leveraging reusable modules and Infrastructure as Code (IaC) best practices enabling consistent, scalable and repeatable deployments across environments.
- Governed Terraform state through remote backends, state locking and environment-level segregation across development, staging and production, preventing concurrent changes and state conflicts.
- Performed Terraform resource import, state migration and state recovery for enterprise-scale environments, ensuring infrastructure consistency and zero drift across deployments.
- Developed and maintained multi-stage YAML pipelines using Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions, incorporating security scanning, validation, testing, approval gates and automated deployments across environments.
- Integrated security tools like TFLint, GitLeaks, Checkov, TFSec, TruffleHog and Infracost into CI/CD pipelines, enforcing automated quality, security, compliance and cost-control checks before deployment.
- Governed source code across GitHub and Azure Repos using trunk-based development, branch protection, pull requests, mandatory code reviews and merge conflict resolution ensuring change traceability and controlled releases.
- Administered identity and privileged access through Microsoft Entra ID, RBAC, MFA, PIM, Managed Identities and Service Principals, enforcing least-privilege and secure authentication practices.
- Implemented Azure Monitor, Log Analytics, dashboards and proactive alerting to strengthen infrastructure observability, operational visibility and incident response.
- Reduced monthly Azure expenditure by 20% through resource utilization analysis, removal of underutilized services and Azure Cost Management dashboards.
- Implemented Azure Backup, Recovery Services Vault and Azure Site Recovery (ASR) to protect critical workloads and support RTO/RPO-driven business continuity, disaster recovery and failover readiness.

Cloud & DevOps Engineer

Jan 2022 - Feb 2023

Rakuten Symphony

- Provisioned and managed Azure compute, storage, identity and networking services, including VMs, VMSS, Managed Disks, VNets, NSGs, UDRs, NAT Gateway, Load Balancers, Application Gateway, Azure Firewall and Bastion.
- Automated end-to-end Azure infrastructure provisioning using Terraform, enabling repeatable and consistent deployments across development, UAT and production environments.
- Developed and maintained Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines for infrastructure validation, approval-controlled releases and automated deployments.
- Implemented Microsoft Entra ID, RBAC, MFA and PIM controls to enforce least-privilege access and strengthen cloud security posture.
- Configured Azure Monitor and Log Analytics for centralized monitoring, logging and alerting, performed production troubleshooting and performance optimization to improve service reliability.

Cloud Infrastructure Engineer

Nov 2019 - Mar 2021

Vodafone Idea

- Administered Linux/Unix-based production servers and cloud infrastructure, ensuring high availability, operational stability and service reliability.
- Provisioned virtual machines, storage, networking and system resources based on workload and business requirements.
- Managed user access, system configurations and infrastructure documentation while adhering to operational and security best practices.
- Monitored infrastructure health, performance, and resource utilization, proactively troubleshooting and resolving production issues.

Senior System Engineer

Nov 2016 - Nov 2019

Nokia

- Managed and administered mission-critical production infrastructure, ensuring high availability, reliability and compliance with organizational SLAs.
- Administered Windows and Linux servers, performing system installation, configuration, hardening, patch management and security updates.
- Automated routine validation and configuration tasks using shell scripting, reducing manual intervention and improving efficiency.
- Monitored and troubleshoot system and network issues, enhancing uptime and reliability in production environments.
- Executed change management and deployment activities following operational and security best practices.

System Engineer

Apr 2012 - Oct 2016

Vodafone

- Administered enterprise Linux/Unix infrastructure and OSS platforms supporting secure, stable and highly available telecom operations.
- Delivered 24x7 production support through infrastructure monitoring, critical incident handling and SLA-focused service restoration.
- Provisioned infrastructure components for node integration, capacity expansion and production deployment activities.
- Performed fault monitoring, alarm handling and incident resolution to reduce downtime and improve service availability.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology - Electronics and Communication Engineering

2007 - 2011

West Bengal University of Technology (WBUT)